

CIDA

Social Media Launch Strategy & Plan of Action

Modern luxury, rooted in Indian heritage.

What We Will Cover

- 01 Brand Positioning & Communication
- 02 SMM Brand Guidelines (Visual, Voice, Dos/Don'ts)
- 03 Social Media Strategy & Content Pillars
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"Every post earns its place in a feed that feels like a private atelier, not a marketplace."

CIDA Content Strategy

Brand Positioning & Audience

POSITIONING

A globally respected Indian luxury fragrance house built on quality, craftsmanship and timeless design. Modern luxury rooted in Indian heritage: history, craftsmanship and storytelling across perfumes and candles.

PERSONALITY

Elegant. Sophisticated. Timeless. Authentic. Detail-oriented. Confident without ever being loud. The brand behaves like an institution, not a startup.

AUDIENCE

Men & women, 25 to 50, who appreciate luxury, craftsmanship and niche fragrance. Metro India: Delhi NCR, Mumbai, Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Chandigarh, Pune.

VISION

To build a globally respected Indian luxury fragrance house, known for exceptional quality, craftsmanship and timeless design. Heritage is structural, not decorative.

How CIDA Communicates

I

Atmosphere, Not Argument

CIDA renders information as mood, moment and memory. The audience leaves content with a feeling they cannot fully articulate.

II

Institution, Not Startup

Nothing should suggest a brand trying to be noticed. Everything suggests a brand that has existed, quietly, for longer than the audience realises.

III

Structural Heritage

India is not a chapter; it is the architecture the entire story is built on. It shows in the weight of a shadow, the grain of a material, the rhythm of a ritual.

The test: "Does this feel inevitable, as though CIDA could not have said it any other way?"

Visual Identity for Social

PHOTOGRAPHY DIRECTION

- Macro and texture-focused: extreme close-ups of materials, surfaces, light
- Negative space as a design tool, never decorative emptiness
- Natural light only: golden hour, dusk, indirect daylight. No flash or studio harshness
- Warm, muted palette: desaturated golds, charcoals, stone tones, aged brass
- Cinematic framing: 16:9 for Reels, 4:5 for feed. No centred product shots
- Heritage textures (jali, sandstone, linen, brass) as recurring visual motifs

INSTAGRAM GRID AESTHETIC

- Dark, minimal, gallery-like. Each row should feel curated as a triptych.
- Alternate between close texture, mid-range composition, and negative space.
- No two product shots adjacent. Product appears in every 3rd to 4th post maximum.
- Maintain tonal consistency: warm blacks, muted golds, stone neutrals across all posts.

SOCIAL COLOUR PALETTE

	Primary Black #0F0F0F	Backgrounds, dominant tone
	Warm Gold #C4A265	Accents, text highlights, lines
	Stone Cream #F5F0EB	Body text on dark, light backgrounds
	Charcoal #2A2A2A	Cards, secondary surfaces
	Muted Grey #999999	Captions, secondary text only

TYPOGRAPHY ON GRAPHICS

Headlines:	Serif (Cambria / brand serif). Spaced, 36pt+. Never all-caps.
Body:	Sans-serif (Calibri / Arial). 14 to 16pt. Left-aligned.
Captions:	Light weight, 10 to 12pt, muted grey. Minimal words.
On-image text:	Use sparingly. White or gold on dark only. Max 8 words.

All visual content must pass the institutional test: would a heritage maison post this?

Voice, Copy & Caption Rules

CIDA's written voice is observational, unhurried, and considered. It never explains; it evokes.

CAPTION STRUCTURE

LENGTH

1 to 3 sentences maximum. Shorter is always better. The image leads.

tone

Observational, not descriptive. Note what is happening, not what the product does.

STRUCTURE

Opening line carries the mood. No greeting, no question hook, no CTA.

PRODUCT MENTION

Name appears once, at the end, or not at all. Never the first word.

LINE BREAKS

Use line breaks for rhythm. Each sentence is its own breath.

EMOJI

Never. Zero exceptions. Punctuation and spacing do the work.

LANGUAGE RULES

- No superlatives ('best', 'finest', 'most luxurious')
- No exclamation marks. Period.
- No hashtags in captions (place in first comment)
- No direct CTAs ('Shop now', 'Link in bio', 'Don't miss')
- No trend-chasing language ('obsessed', 'slay', 'vibes')
- No competitor references or comparison language
- No price mentions in organic content

CAPTION EXAMPLES

"The weight of glass. The resistance of a cap turned slowly. Some details are felt before they are seen."

"Morning light finds the brass first."

"Before the name, the feeling. Aqua Eclipse."

Social Media Dos and Don'ts

ALWAYS

- + Treat the feed as a curated gallery; every post earns its place
- + Use silence, negative space and ambient sound as creative tools
- + Let the product speak through craft, never through claims
- + Maintain 48-hour minimum between feed posts (unhurried cadence)
- + Reply to comments with the same considered tone as captions
- + Credit all collaborators, spaces and artisans authentically
- + Use Stories for ephemeral intimacy; feed for permanent editorial
- + Post during metro India evening hours: 6 to 9 PM IST

NEVER

- Loud, shouty marketing or promotional language
- Discount, sale or urgency-driven messaging
- Mass influencer collaborations or paid endorsements
- Reposting UGC that dilutes the visual standard
- Trend-jacking or meme formats, however tempting
- Flat product-on-white catalogue-style photography
- Over-posting: more than 5 feed posts per week
- Engagement bait: polls, 'tag a friend', giveaways

CONTENT FORMAT SPECIFICATIONS

FEED POST	4:5 (1080x1350)	Primary format. Macro, texture, still life.	CAROUSEL	4:5 (1080x1350)	4 to 6 slides. No text overlays on images.	REELS	9:16 (1080x1920)	15 to 30s. Ambient sound, no music, no voiceover.
STORIES	9:16 (1080x1920)	Behind-the-scenes. Ephemeral. Minimal text.	YOUTUBE	16:9 (1920x1080)	60 to 90s films. Cinematic. Sound design led.	PINTEREST	2:3 (1000x1500)	Vertical. Mood boards, material studies.

Emotional Architecture

The sequence of emotional states CIDA must consistently produce.

01

Stillness

Interrupt the scroll. Negative space, unhurried pacing, images that demand pause. The first reaction: 'Wait.'

AWARENESS

02

Intimacy

Reward the pause with closeness. Macro textures, unhurried process, the sound of glass. Witnessing, not being pitched.

ENGAGEMENT

03

Recognition

The moment they feel CIDA understands a sensibility they hold but haven't seen articulated. Taste recognition.

CONSIDERATION

04

Belonging

Part of a world with its own language and rituals. Customers become custodians who defend, gift and speak of the brand.

LOYALTY

Social Media Strategy

STRATEGIC PILLARS

Sensory-First Storytelling

Translate scent into visual and emotional language. Every post creates a mood the audience can feel before they smell.

Institutional Cadence

Post with the rhythm of a luxury house, not a startup. Quality over frequency. Restraint is the strategy.

Heritage as Subtext

Indian identity woven into light, texture, material and ritual. Never declared, always felt.

Community Through Curation

Build belonging by sharing a world view on design, craft, space and scent. Not a product feed; a publication.

TONE GUARDRAILS

ALWAYS

- + Speak in atmosphere and sensory language
- + Let silence and negative space carry meaning
- + Treat every post as editorial content
- + Maintain unhurried pacing across all formats

NEVER

- Loud, shouty marketing or CTAs
- Discount-led or sale-driven messaging
- Excessive influencer collaborations
- Trading restraint for reach

Six Creative Territories

01

25%

The Grammar of Scent

Translate fragrance into light, texture, temperature and memory. Sensory studies, not note pyramids.

02

20%

Objects of Intention

Craftsmanship through the object itself. Glass weight, cap resistance, grain of the box.

03

15%

The Quiet Ordinary

Fragrance woven into unhurried rituals. Morning light, linen, a table set for one.

04

15%

Studies in Material

Ingredient stories told as design research, not marketing. Origin, texture, transformation.

05

15%

The CIDA Atlas

Architecture, interiors, travel, spaces. A point of view on design, not only fragrance.

06

10%

Correspondences

Short written pieces on restraint, craft, memory. Intellectual voice independent of imagery.

Platform Strategy

INSTAGRAM

Primary Brand Home

4 to 5 posts/week

Feed: curated grid, editorial photography, macro textures, sensory films. Stories: behind-the-scenes glimpses, ephemeral intimacy. Reels: slow-motion sensory content, ambient soundscapes, process videos.

FORMATS: Carousels, Single Image, Reels (15 to 30s), Stories

YOUTUBE

Long-Form Storytelling

2 to 3 videos/month

Cinematic fragrance films (60 to 90s), material origin stories, founder narrative, architecture of scent documentary-style content. Shorts for cross-platform sensory teasers.

FORMATS: Short Films, Shorts, Documentary Edits

PINTEREST

Discovery & Aspiration

8 to 10 pins/week

Mood boards, texture studies, architectural references, scent-inspired palettes. Drive evergreen discovery traffic. Boards organised by fragrance and by sensory territory.

FORMATS: Pins, Idea Pins, Boards

The Launch Fragrances

AQUA ECLIPSE

Aqua Eclipse

Shore meets sea. Moonlit waters, endless horizons.

KEY NOTES

Bergamot / Seaweed / Musk

SENSORY TERRITORY

Fresh, marine, calm clarity

TAHITIAN SPICE

Tahitian Spice

Tropical air. Ripe fruit, warm spice, glowing warmth.

KEY NOTES

Cardamom / Vetiver / Patchouli

SENSORY TERRITORY

Warm, sensual, radiant desire

OBSIDIAN ROSE

Obsidian Rose

Shadow and light. Dark florals, velvet warmth.

KEY NOTES

Indian Damask Rose / Violet Leaf / Orris Root

SENSORY TERRITORY

Mysterious, powerful, tranquil elegance

Launch Campaign Architecture

A three-phase structure that mirrors the emotional architecture: Stillness, Intimacy, then Belonging.

PHASE I

The Whisper

Weeks 1 to 4 | Stillness + Intrigue

- Cryptic sensory teasers (no product shown)
- Ambient soundscapes + macro textures
- Single-word captions: 'Wait.' / 'Before.'
- Dark, minimal grid establishment
- Heritage textures: jali, brass, stone

KPI: Profile visits, Saves, Follower growth

PHASE II

The Reveal

Weeks 5 to 8 | Intimacy + Recognition

- Fragrance reveal, one per week
- Cinematic sensory films per scent
- Objects of Intention: packaging close-ups
- Material origin stories (ingredient studies)
- Founder voice: Correspondences territory

KPI: Engagement rate, Shares, DMs, Website clicks

PHASE III

The World

Weeks 9 to 12 | Belonging + Conversion

- Full collection showcase + discovery set
- The Quiet Ordinary: lifestyle integration
- The CIDA Atlas: architecture + space content
- Community rituals: 'The Evening Hour'
- Curated seeding to design-aligned tastemakers

KPI: Conversions, UGC, Repeat engagement, Community

Campaign I: The Unseen Hour

CONCEPT

A recurring series posted at dusk (the golden hour), capturing the liminal moment between day and night. Each post is a single, still frame: a window, a shadow, light through fabric, condensation on glass. No product for the first 3 weeks. The fragrance appears only as a silhouette in week 4.

EXECUTION

- Week 1: 3 posts. Textures only (stone, linen, brass). Caption: single word.
- Week 2: 3 posts. Light studies. Jali shadows, water reflection, warm stone.
- Week 3: 3 posts. Ambient Reels with sound design. No narration.
- Week 4: Bottle silhouette reveal. Caption: 'C I D A. Before the name, the feeling.'

ORGANIC GROWTH MECHANICS

SAVE TRIGGERS

Visually arresting imagery designed to be bookmarked; aspirational texture mood boards.

SHARE TRIGGERS

Mysterious, conversation-starting posts that prompt DM shares ('what is this brand?').

DISCOVERY

Hashtag strategy: #QuietLuxury #NicheFragrance #IndianCraftsmanship. Pinterest cross-posting.

SEO

Alt text and captions optimised for fragrance + luxury + heritage search terms.

TERRITORY: The Grammar of Scent + Correspondences

Campaign II: Three Rooms

Each fragrance is a room. The audience enters each one.

AQUA ECLIPSE

The Shore Room

Bleached linen, driftwood, moonlight on water. Cool mineral surfaces. The sound of distant waves. Content shot at dawn with silver-blue tones.

HERO CONTENT

5-image carousel: water on stone, sea glass, linen in breeze, brass compass, bottle on wet marble.

TAHITIAN SPICE

The Spice Room

Warm wood, candlelight, dried botanicals. Rich amber tones. The sound of mortar and pestle. Content shot in golden hour with deep warmth.

HERO CONTENT

60s Reel: hands crushing cardamom, vetiver root close-up, patchouli leaf texture, bottle emerging from shadow.

OBSIDIAN ROSE

The Garden Room

Dusk garden, velvet, old stone walls. Deep burgundy and charcoal. The sound of evening birds. Content shot at dusk with dramatic shadows.

HERO CONTENT

Cinematic short: dawn mist in a rose garden, dew on petals, hand touching stone, bottle in evening light.

Campaign III: The Making

CONCEPT

A slow-release documentary series that follows the craft behind CIDA without explaining it. No voiceover. No text overlay. Just process: hands at work, materials being shaped, light falling on surfaces during creation. Positioned as Objects of Intention meets Studies in Material.

FORMAT BREAKDOWN

- Reels (15 to 30s): Single-material focus. Hands crushing spice, glass being shaped, cap being turned.
- Carousels (4 to 6 images): Raw material to finished object. No captions on images; story in carousel copy.
- YouTube Short (60s): Ambient workshop film. Sound design is the narrative: clinking glass, pouring liquid, closing a box.
- Feed Post: Final object, perfectly lit. Caption: a single observation about craft.

CAMPAIGN IV: CORRESPONDENCES

Short written provocations set against textured backgrounds. No product. No imagery. Just thought.

SAMPLE LINES

"The best scent is the one that makes you pause mid-sentence."

"Luxury is not ornament. It is the absence of anything that does not belong."

"We do not make perfume for those who want to be noticed. We make it for those who want to be remembered."

"Restraint is the most difficult thing to design. And the first thing people feel."

FORMAT: Single text on textured background. Stories + Feed. Screenshot-worthy.

12-Week Launch Calendar

WEEK	THEME	CONTENT FOCUS	TERRITORY	POSTS
1	Stillness Begins	Texture teasers, ambient Reels	Grammar of Scent	3
2	Light Studies	Jali shadows, warm stone, water	Grammar of Scent	3
3	Sound of Silence	Ambient soundscapes, no product	Correspondences	3
4	The Silhouette	Bottle reveal (shadow only)	Objects of Intention	4
5	Aqua Eclipse	Fragrance I reveal + sensory film	Grammar + Material	4
6	Tahitian Spice	Fragrance II reveal + ingredients	Grammar + Material	4
7	Obsidian Rose	Fragrance III reveal + film	Grammar + Material	4
8	The Making	Process content, craft stories	Objects of Intention	4
9	The Collection	Full range + discovery set	Objects + Atlas	5
10	The Quiet Ordinary	Lifestyle integration, rituals	Quiet Ordinary	4
11	The CIDA Atlas	Architecture, space, design	CIDA Atlas	4
12	Belonging	Community, founder voice, UGC	Correspondences	4

PHASE I
The Whisper

PHASE II
The Reveal

PHASE III
The World

Organic Growth Framework

Save-First Content Design

Every post designed to earn saves, not just likes. Mood boards, sensory studies, and written provocations that audiences bookmark and return to.

Target: 5%+ save rate

Strategic Seeding

Curated gifting to 15 to 20 design-aligned tastemakers (architects, chefs, stylists, editors). Not influencer marketing; taste-aligned recognition.

Target: 10 to 15 organic mentions

Cross-Platform Storytelling

Instagram for atmosphere, Pinterest for discovery, YouTube for depth. Same sensory DNA, platform-native formats. Each drives traffic to the others.

Target: 30% multi-platform audience

Community Rituals

'The Evening Hour': weekly recurring content moment at dusk. Builds habit, anticipation and a shared temporal ritual with the audience.

Target: 2x engagement vs. non-ritual posts

Algorithmic Optimisation

Reels (15 to 30s) for reach, Carousels for saves, Stories for intimacy. Post timing aligned with metro India evening hours (6 to 9 PM IST).

Target: 8%+ engagement rate

Hashtag Architecture

Branded: #CIDA #CIDAfragrance. Community: #QuietLuxury #ScentAsMemory. Discovery: #NicheFragranceIndia #IndianCraftsmanship

Target: Top 9 in niche hashtags

Visual References

Reel References

1. <https://www.instagram.com/reel/DZCT5hMtkwU/?stkn=eGUwbDc1MiltNHo5>
2. <https://www.instagram.com/reel/DYXXvyDNK3N/?stkn=NHJsaDh1ZzV4Z3p2>
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CIDA

Modern luxury, rooted in Indian heritage.

Let us build a world, not just a feed.